

Writing

A review of an event

1 Work in pairs and discuss. Have you been to see any well-known bands or singers in concert? If so, describe the experience. If not, which group/singer would you like to see?

2a Read the review and answer the questions.

- 1 What did the reviewer like about the concert?
- 2 What didn't he like?

b Tick the things below that the reviewer describes. What else do you think he should have described?

- | | |
|----------------------------------|--------------------|
| • the reason for going | • the atmosphere |
| • the reactions of the crowd | • the songs played |
| • how many people were there | • the highlights |
| • the quality of the performance | • the negatives |
| • the names of the band members | |

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Coldplay aren't the youngest band on the music scene, or the coolest, but they're definitely one of the best live bands performing today. Consequently, as soon as I knew they were coming to Toronto, where I live, I booked my ticket!

Standing in the arena last night, the atmosphere was electric. The two women sitting next to me were cheering and singing (very badly) before the band had even come on stage. And when the concert finally started an hour later than planned, no one seemed to mind. The concert itself lasted for over two hours and included some of their biggest hits, such as 'Viva La Vida'. The crowd loved them all, though perhaps the highlight for me was 'Yellow', from their debut album *Parachutes*. Singing along to that with the thousands of other fans in the arena was an unforgettable experience.

The only problem for me was that their big hits weren't all that they played. Quite a lot of the songs were from their latest album, currently standing at the top of the charts. I haven't bought this album, although I think I was the only person in the arena who hadn't. As a result, when the concert finished, I felt like I'd been to my best friend's wedding but hadn't been given a piece of wedding cake. It was a great experience – but something was missing.

Next time Coldplay are in town, I'll definitely go again, but I'll make sure I know their latest album off by heart beforehand and I'll sit a bit further away from the two women with tuneless voices trying to sing louder than the lead singer!

3a Find sentences in the review which mean the same as the ones below. What are the differences?

- 1 They're definitely one of the best live bands who are performing today.
- 2 The two women who were sitting next to me were cheering ...
- 3 No one who was sitting in the arena seemed to mind.
- 4 Quite a lot of the songs were from their latest album, which is currently standing at the top of the charts.
- 5 I'll sit a bit further away from the two women with tuneless voices who were trying to sing louder than the lead singer.

b Cross out words from the relative clauses in the sentences below, if possible.

- 1 I felt sorry for the people ~~who were~~ queuing in the rain to get a ticket.
- 2 The band ~~who I was watching~~ on the main stage were awful.
- 3 The person ~~who was sitting next to me~~ fell asleep.
- 4 Who's that girl in the crowd ~~who is waving~~ at us?
- 5 The band ~~that we are listening to~~ are looking for a new drummer.
- 6 I haven't heard this song ~~that is playing now~~.
- 7 I know that guy ~~who is playing drums~~ on stage.
- 8 Where did you download that music ~~we're listening to~~?

4a Think of a festival, play, comedy show, etc. that you have been to or seen. Make notes on the topics in exercise 2b.

b Organise your notes into paragraphs, then write the first draft of your review.

5a Write a final draft of your review using the checklist below.

- Have you used interesting and rich language to describe the event?
- Have you used relative clauses correctly?
- Are the spelling, grammar and punctuation correct?
- Have you included information about some of the topics in exercise 2a?

b Work in pairs. Swap reviews with a partner and take turns to give each other feedback.